

Music City

Verifiable music ownership and royalty payouts on Stellar

BUILDER

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CHAPTER

Southern Africa

CHAPTER LEAD

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PROPOSED SPRINT

27 July–25 August 2026

SUBMISSION DATE

To be confirmed

1. Project Summary

Music City is a music platform that helps artists document ownership splits, track qualified listening activity, and receive transparent royalty payouts through Stellar.

The working MVP already includes Stellar wallet connection, artist onboarding, track upload and streaming, subscriptions, royalty accounting, admin payout controls, and testnet USDC payments.

2. Problem and Objective

Problem

Independent artists often lack a clear, verifiable record of who owns a track and how its income should be shared. Music City currently stores royalty splits in its application database, so the active split cannot yet be independently verified on Stellar.

30-Day Objective

Deploy a Soroban royalty-split registry on Stellar Testnet, connect it to Music City, and demonstrate the complete flow from track ownership records to a verifiable testnet USDC royalty payout.

3. Deliverables

Deliverable 1 — Soroban Royalty Registry

Build and deploy a tested Soroban contract that stores versioned royalty splits for each track and confirms that all recipient shares total 100%.

Evidence: public source code, passing contract tests, testnet contract ID, and explorer transaction.

Deliverable 2 — Music City Integration

Add backend and admin tools to publish an approved split to Soroban, read it back, store its transaction details, and show whether the application record matches the on-chain record.

Evidence: repository commit, automated tests, admin screenshots, and public transaction links.

Deliverable 3 — Testnet Demo

Record a short demonstration showing the artist, track, royalty recipients, Soroban split verification, royalty ledger, and a successful testnet USDC payout.

Evidence: 3–5 minute video, screenshots, final repository commit, contract ID, payment hash, and reviewer guide.

4. Timeline

Week	Work	Output
Week 1	Design and build the Soroban contract and tests.	Tested contract source.
Week 2	Deploy to testnet and build backend publish/read functions.	Contract ID and working API integration.
Week 3	Add admin publish, verification, and explorer links.	Working reviewer-facing interface.
Week 4	Complete testing, fix defects, and capture evidence.	Demo video and final evidence pack.

5. Budget

Work	Amount
Soroban contract engineering and tests	\$2,000
Backend and admin integration	\$1,500
End-to-end testnet QA and demo	\$1,000
Documentation and evidence packaging	\$500
Total requested	\$5,000

Requested as the USD equivalent paid in XLM, subject to Instawards approval and current program rules.

6. Current Evidence

- Repository: github.com/music-city/music-city
- All workspace typechecks passed on 21 July 2026.
- All 45 server tests passed.
- All production builds completed successfully.
- Music City has an active Stellar Testnet treasury with an established USDC trustline.
- A confirmed outbound payment of 3 testnet USDC is publicly verifiable.

Verified payment:

058bab23795850e40565704ea07fc7641ce13947070a67437ee3f568de1c8e63

7. Out of Scope

- Mainnet deployment or real customer funds.
- One blockchain payment for every individual play; royalties will be settled in auditable batches.
- Arweave/Irys migration, mobile applications, scheduled payouts, and record-label contracts.
- Legal copyright registration or replacement of statutory royalty systems.

8. Required Before Submission

- ☐ Confirm the sprint dates and actual submission date.
- ☐ Add public client, API, and admin URLs.
- ☐ Add a short founder biography.
- ☐ Add Southern Africa chapter-engagement evidence.
- ☐ Confirm prior Instaward/SCF funding history.
- ☐ Confirm KYC readiness and the public disbursement wallet.
- ☐ Confirm that the GitHub repository opens to a logged-out reviewer.

9. Acknowledgement

- ☐ The work can be completed within 30 calendar days.
- ☐ The request funds new, defined work rather than completed work.
- ☐ Progress will be measured against the deliverables and evidence above.
- ☐ The builder will complete the required KYC process if approved.
- ☐ Submission does not guarantee approval or funding.

Prepared for review with Yaliwe Mlambo, Southern Africa Ambassador Chapter Lead. Draft prepared 21 July 2026.